WELCOME TO THE *MULTIVERSE*

INDIAN PRODUCTION HOUSES ARE GOING THE MARVEL AND DISNEY WAY AND CREATING PARALLEL UNIVERSES POPULATED BY DIVERSE CHARACTERS AND THEMES. INDIAN AUDIENCES CANNOT HAVE ENOUGH

By **SUHANI SINGH**



IT **WOULD BE HARD TO TOP A MORE RAPTUROUS** moment in Indian cinema than when Shah Rukh Khan's Pathaan meets Salman Khan's Tiger in *Pathaan* (2023) for some good-natured banter. Salman's delightful cameo brought some lighthearted humour into some pretty serious proceedings, but it was not exactly an unexpected appearance in the light of producers Yash Raj Films' announcement of building a whole Spy Universe. Setting it up was also a sound business move for the studio, given that its biggest hits in the past decade have all been spy-led action spectacles, be it *Ek Tha Tiger* in 2012, *Tiger Zinda Hai* in 2017, *War* in 2019 and *Pathaan* now. "With *Pathaan*, *War* and *Tiger*, we now have three of the biggest IPs [intellectual properties] in Indian cinema in the same cinematic spy universe!" Akshaye Widhani, the CEO of YRF Studios, said after *Pathaan*'s success. "The YRF Spy Universe is expanding at an unimaginable rate and all its productions are now the biggest event films for audiences to enjoy in theatres. It's an incredible track record for YRF, which also shows audiences are